

Design tradeoffs

Synthetic course reading snapshot: 2026-09-14

Every design choice privileges one value while placing another value under constraint.

Reading move

Mark the boundary, name the assumption, and state the evidence that would change your current model. In Course Beta, this move supports B-201 Scenario Map, B-202 Model Test, and B-203 Design Critique.

Discussion prompt

What changes when the same situation is framed with a wider boundary? Give one observation and explain what it would mean for a model.

Rubric connection

Use the 20-point shared rubric: Evidence 6, Reasoning 6, Organization 4, and Format 4. Draft concise evidence-based claims instead of collecting disconnected terms.

Cycle	Question
Boundary	What is included?
Assumption	What are we treating as true?
Model	What relationship are we proposing?
Test	What could revise it?
Critique	What design move follows?